

L2A™

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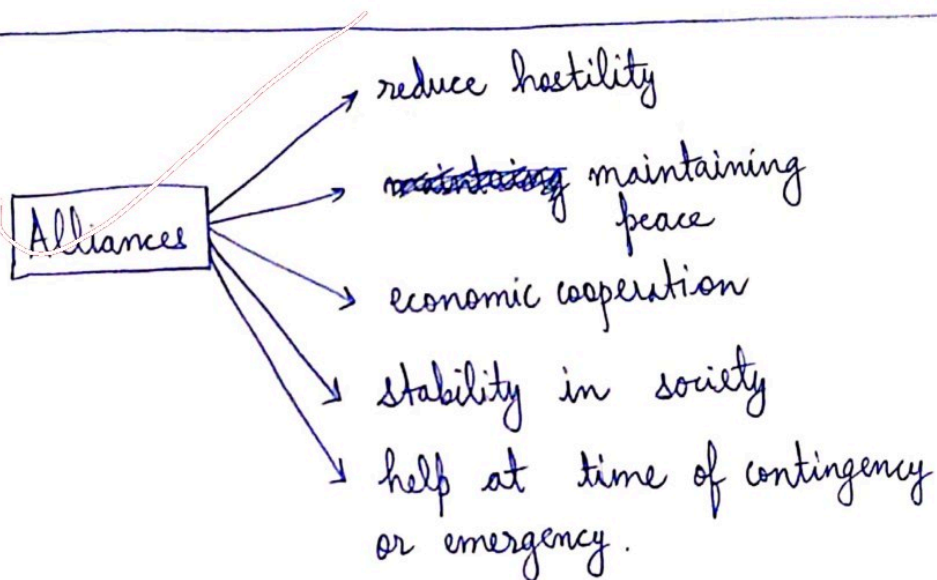
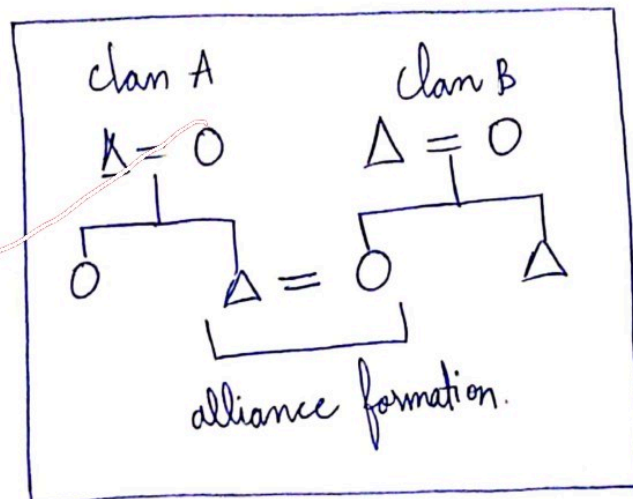
(b) Write in brief about alliance theory in kinship

Alliance Theory was proposed by Levi Strauss in his book 'The Elementary Structure of Kinship (1964)'

He ~~ss~~ stressed upon the role of affinal relationships in maintaining stability and peace in the society.

Various clans enter into different alliances so as to reduce hostility and start cooperation. ~~ss~~

He argued that the 'principle of reciprocity' is universal. Exchange of women takes place between ~~allians~~ various clans in order to establish an alliance.



Levi Strauss also stressed that due to incest taboo, various groups started practising clan exogamy so as to make new alliances.

Criticism

- 1) Feminist criticised Alliance Theory of objectifying the women.
- 2) Decent theorists argued the consanguineous relations were ignored.

Hence, Alliance Theory in kinship tries to explain how various social relations are governed within and between various clans.

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